

Isolation means:

One container cannot interfere with another container or the host system.

1. What is Docker?

Docker is a containerization platform that packages an application and its dependencies into a single container that runs consistently across environments.

2. Containers vs Virtual Machines (VMs)?

Docker containers share the host OS kernel, are lightweight & start faster, while VMs include separate OS instances.

3. What are images and containers?

- *Image*: Read-only template
- *Container*: A running instance of an image.

4. What is a Dockerfile?

A text file with instructions to build a Docker image (base image, commands, ENV variables).

5. What is Docker Compose?

A tool to define and run multi-container applications with a docker-compose.yml.

Intermediate Docker Questions

6. Explain Docker networking.

Docker networks enable containers to communicate via bridge, host, or overlay networks.

7. What are Docker volumes?

Volumes store persistent data that containers can share or preserve across restarts.

8. How to optimize Docker images?

Use minimal base images, multi-stage builds, fewer layers, and clean caches.

9. Difference between CMD and ENTRYPOINT?

ENTRYPOINT sets the executable; CMD provides default arguments.

10. Explain container isolation.

Docker uses namespaces (for processes) and cgroups (for resource limits).

Advanced Docker Questions

11. What is Docker Swarm?

Native Docker orchestration for clustering containers.

12. How is container orchestration handled?

Tools like Kubernetes manage scaling, load balancing, and availability.

13. How do you secure Docker containers?

Run with least privilege, use trusted images, scan images for vulnerabilities, apply AppArmor/SELinux policies.

14. What is multi-stage build?

Reduces final image size by separating build and runtime stages.

15. Scenario: A Docker image is too large — how do you reduce it?

Remove unnecessary tools, use smaller base, multi-stage builds, minimize layers.

What is Docker Networking (Simple Definition)

Docker networking allows containers to talk to:

- Other containers
- The host machine
- The outside world (internet)

Each container has:

- Its own **IP**
- Its own **network namespace**

Docker creates **virtual networks** to manage communication.

2 Types of Docker Networks (With Clear Use Cases)

◆ 1. Bridge Network (MOST COMMON)

📌 Default network

- Containers can talk to each other using **container name**
- Used for **single-host applications**

Example:

`docker network create my-network`

👉 Best for:

- Backend + DB containers
 - Local development
 - Microservices on one server
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◆ 2. Host Network

- Container shares **host's network**
- No isolation
- Faster, but **less secure**

👉 Used when:

- Performance is critical
 - Legacy apps need host networking
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◆ 3. Overlay Network

- Used in **Docker Swarm / Kubernetes**
- Enables communication across **multiple hosts**

👉 Used in:

- Production clusters
- Distributed microservices

◆ 4. None Network

- No network access
- Fully isolated container